

world where activists protest or target information of the group they're protesting against. They gain access to government or private databases to obtain confidential information that could be used against the corporation. They could also disrupt the functioning of a site or shut it down completely as a form of protest. Though hacktivists don't commit cyber crime for personal/monetary gain, it still affects the privacy of a group of people and poses a risk to virtually stored information.

Cyber crime is easy

Considering the number of ways by which perpetrators can affect our lives using the internet, it's no puzzle to see why they're doing it. It's easy. Other than just the profitable nature of committing crimes online, there are many more reasons why the internet is a hot bed of criminal activity for most. Firstly, heavy initial investment is not needed. In petty, traditional crimes such as mugging, the perpetrators are required to have the basic know-how and/or weapons with them. For a more complex crime such as robbing a bank, the criminals are required to have a network of allies and equipment along with them to successfully execute the plan. This, of course, requires a lot of planning and finances. On the other hand, for a hacker to gain access to your account details or finances, access to a computer and technical know-how is all that is required. There's also the additional risk of retaliation from the victim or the chance of being caught in the act, which is much higher in the physical world. This could result in injury and legal action against the perpetrator. Online though, the evil techie could easily operate from a remote location where law enforcement doesn't pose so much of a risk. For him, it's a global playground where there's less risk of being caught while playing dirty. Through the very systems that run e-commerce, they are easily able to commit crimes. Thus, the

entry into the cybercriminal world is much easier than in the real world. Add to the fact that on the internet there's not much competition or rivalry that exists in the real world. Infact, groups of online infiltrators often collaborate to improve their skills and seek out new opportunities, unlike real world gangs who fight for control. The icing on the cake is the advantage of

